



## COLLEGE OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE (CBEREC)

Dear CH Zulu,

### ETHICAL APPROVAL GRANTED FOR RESEARCH PROJECT

**Decision: Clearance granted**

This letter serves to confirm that the proposed research project indicated in the table below, has been reviewed by the School of Consumer Intelligence and Information Systems (SCiISREC) Research Ethics Committee of the University of Johannesburg (UJ). Ethical clearance is hereby granted and is valid for three years, from 1 May 2026 until 30 April 2029.

|                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Applicant</b>                                                                                                                                                   | CH Zulu                                                                                 |
| <b>Supervisor/s</b>                                                                                                                                                | Dr S Mhlongo                                                                            |
| <b>Student/staff number</b>                                                                                                                                        | 226166283                                                                               |
| <b>Title</b>                                                                                                                                                       | The role of IT leadership in realising the return on investment of AI coding assistants |
| <b>Decision date at meeting</b>                                                                                                                                    | 30 April 2026                                                                           |
| <b>Reviewers</b>                                                                                                                                                   | SCIISREC 2/9 RV1 V2 AISREC Dr F Radebe; Dr S Dube                                       |
| <b>Ethical clearance code</b>                                                                                                                                      | 2026SCiIS024                                                                            |
| <b>Rating of application</b>                                                                                                                                       | CODE 01                                                                                 |
| CODE 01 – Approved<br>CODE 02 – Approved with suggestions/requirements with no re-submission<br>CODE 03 – Referred back<br>CODE 04 – Disapproved, cannot re-submit |                                                                                         |

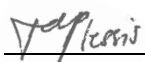
### The researcher/s may now commence with the study providing that:

1. Researcher/s, i.e. internal and/or external applicants, who wish to undertake research at the University of Johannesburg (UJ) case institution as data collection source involving UJ students and/or UJ staff and/or any UJ support services submit the Personal Information Impact Assessment (PIIA) via the [2026 UJ Gatekeeper Platform](#), after familiarising themselves with the [UJ POPIA and PAIA manual](#) and, if applicable, utilising the [UJ login to register POPI requests](#).
2. The researcher/s understand the implications of any form of data breach and takes responsibility for any possible violation or any form of unethical research conduct. The onus is on the researcher/s to ensure that the project adheres to ethical research requirements.

3. The researcher/s will be conducting the study as set out in the approval application, i.e. Form\_7a and/or Form\_7b linked to the departmentally approved research proposal that was submitted by the researcher/s, together with supporting documents, primary data collection, and/or secondary data analysis, to the research ethics committee.
4. The researcher/s will ensure that the project adheres to all applicable legislation, scopes of practice, professional codes of conduct, and scientific standards as it pertains to the field or study.
5. The researcher/s will bring under the attention of the research ethics committee any proposed changes, concerns that arise, and/or unexpected ethical management issues.
6. Any changes that can affect the study-related risks for participants or researchers must be reported immediately to the research ethics committee in writing.
7. No data collection or fieldwork activities may continue after the ethical clearance has expired. A request for an extension of ethical clearance can be made in writing to the research ethics committee.
8. The researcher/s must be aware that infectious diseases may influence researcher/s, research participants, and responses. Steps must be taken to the best of researcher/s' ability to avoid the spread of infectious diseases.
9. Researcher/s familiarise themselves with the [PAIA and POPIA UJ compliance manual](#). All data collection must be done within Government regulations, for instance, researcher/s must uphold all provisions of the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA) Act 4 of 2013 when collecting, processing, and storing data. This includes but is not limited to upholding the principles of accountability, processing restriction, purpose, transparency, processing restrictions, security, and rights of participants.
10. Researcher/s abide by the ethical use of Artificial Intelligence (AI). As non-legal entities, AI tools cannot assert the presence or absence of conflicts of interest nor manage copyright and license agreements. UJ requires researcher/s to disclose any use of AI in the research process and the preparation of their research report to ensure transparency and allow for proper assessment by reviewers and examiners.

The School of Consumer Intelligence and Information Systems Research Ethics Committee wish the researcher/s all the best with this research project.

Kind regards,



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Prof T du Plessis  
**SCiSREC Chair**  
[tduplessis@uj.ac.za](mailto:tduplessis@uj.ac.za)